

OCBC Bank

GE results suggest small downside, capital management to drive the stock

Neutral

OCBC.SI, OCBC.SP

Price (25 Jul 25): S\$17.18

Price Target (Jun-26): S\$18.00

OCBC's insurance subsidiary Great Eastern Holdings reported 2Q25 profits of S\$248mn, down 28% q/q and 11% y/y. OCBC's 93.7% share of earnings accounts for 12% of our 2Q25E forecasts for OCBC, vs. 17% in 1Q25 and 13% average in last 4 quarters. TWNS declined 19% y/y, largely due to Singapore on lower single premium sales, driven by mix shift to longer-term products. NBEV was up 14% y/y and 13% q/q. Losses from ALM mis-match and revaluation of private equity holdings also weighed on 1H25 earnings.

Following in-line results at Bank of Ningbo last week (~14% contribution in line with trend, [link](#)), GE's results suggest small downside to OCBC earnings, to be announced on Friday, August 1. This is in addition to risks to NIM, following declines in SORA and HIBOR in the quarter ([link](#)).

However, post GE corporate action, any shift in payout will be a key driver of the stock. We also await communication on strategy and capital from the incoming CEO.

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Table 1: GE: 2Q25 Earnings Snapshot

S\$mn	2Q25	1Q25	4Q24	3Q24	2Q24	1Q24	QoQ	YoY
Total Weighted New Sales	363.5	345.1	432.7	390.8	448.3	524.2	5%	-19%
New Business Embedded Value	167.7	148.8	105.7	156.1	146.5	125.5	13%	14%
Profit from Insurance Business	168.4	246.8	92.6	186.4	215.4	236.3	-32%	-22%
Profit from Shareholders' Fund	79.8	98.7	42.2	87.0	65.0	70.4	-19%	23%
Profit Attributable to Shareholders	248.2	345.5	134.8	273.4	280.4	306.7	-28%	-11%

Source: Company data.

Table 2: GE: New Business Embedded Value (NBEV) by market

S\$ millions	2Q25	1Q25	4Q24	3Q24	2Q24	1Q24	QoQ	YoY
Singapore	67	71	75	62	58	49	-6%	15%
Malaysia	99	75	115	92	87	75	31%	14%
Emerging Markets	2	2	3	3	2	2	0%	21%
Total	168	149	193	156	147	126	13%	14%

Source: Company data.

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Table 3: GE: Total Weighted New Sales (TWNS) by market

<i>\$ millions</i>	2Q25	1Q25	4Q24	3Q24	2Q24	1Q24	QoQ	YoY
SINGAPORE								
Agency	92	102	135	156	200	277	-10%	-54%
Banca	119	94	84	83	90	119	27%	33%
Others	19	20	10	13	18	18	-7%	4%
<i>Total Weighted New Sales</i>	230	216	229	251	308	414	6%	-25%
MALAYSIA								
Agency	113	90	179	116	103	87	25%	9%
Banca	5	6	9	7	7	6	-5%	-30%
Others	9	26	6	6	24	8	-65%	-61%
<i>Total Weighted New Sales</i>	127	122	194	129	134	102	4%	-5%
OTHER ASIA								
<i>Total Weighted New Sales</i>	7	8	10	10	7	9	-13%	0%
TOTAL								
Total Weighted New Sales	364	345	433	391	448	524	5%	-19%

Source: Company data.

Table 4: OCBC: 2Q25 Earnings Preview

P&L (\$\$mn)	2Q24	3Q24	4Q24	1Q25	2Q25E	YoY	QoQ
Interest Income	5,615	5,596	5,617	5,538	5,426	-3%	-2%
Interest Expense	(3,185)	(3,163)	(3,162)	(3,193)	(3,103)	-3%	-3%
Net Interest Income	2,430	2,433	2,455	2,345	2,324	-4%	-1%
Non-Interest Income	1,199	1,369	961	1,310	1,341	12%	2%
Net Fee Income	466	508	517	546	557	20%	2%
Trading Income	439	628	343	458	472	8%	3%
Other Operating Income	294	233	101	306	312	6%	2%
Total Revenues	3,629	3,802	3,416	3,655	3,665	1%	0%
Costs	(1,373)	(1,463)	(1,560)	(1,415)	(1,430)	4%	1%
PPOP	2,256	2,339	1,856	2,240	2,235	-1%	0%
Loan Loss Provisions	(55)	(169)	(297)	(212)	(163)	197%	-23%
Pre-Tax	2,333	2,414	1,888	2,297	2,336	0%	2%
Tax	(310)	(339)	(235)	(313)	(362)	17%	16%
Profit before MI	2,023	2,075	1,653	1,984	1,974	-2%	-1%
MI and EO	(79)	(101)	34	(101)	(36)	-54%	-64%
Core Attributable Profit	1,944	1,974	1,687	1,883	1,937	0%	3%
Reported Net Profits	1,944	1,974	1,687	1,883	1,937	0%	3%
DPS (\$\$)	0.44	-	0.57	-	0.50	14%	n.a
Common Equity	55,219	55,932	57,616	59,866	61,714	12%	3%
Gross Loans	303,983	305,417	319,166	322,175	326,954	8%	1%
Net Loans	299,980	301,285	315,096	317,885	322,621	8%	1%
Deposits	369,295	369,280	390,687	402,732	406,510	10%	1%
NPLs	2,817	2,745	2,827	2,898	2,979	6%	3%
LLR	4,003	4,132	4,070	4,290	4,333	8%	1%
Change in bps							
NIM	2.20%	2.18%	2.15%	2.04%	1.96%	(24)	(8)
CIR	37.8%	38.5%	45.7%	38.7%	39.0%	119	31
LDR	81%	82%	81%	79%	79%	(187)	43
CASA Ratio	47.8%	48.4%	48.8%	48.9%	49.2%	140	27
Credit Costs (bps)	7	22	38	26	20	13	(6)
NPL Ratio	0.93%	0.90%	0.89%	0.90%	0.91%	(2)	1
Coverage Ratio	142%	151%	144%	148%	145%	336	(257)

Source: Company reports, J.P. Morgan estimates.

Investment Thesis, Valuation and Risks

OCBC Bank *(Neutral; Price Target: S\$18.00)*

Investment Thesis

We hold a Neutral rating on OCBC.

- The bank is targeting to deliver S\$3bn incremental revenues by 2025 (vs. 2022), supported by investments in wholesale banking and WM, among others. These are aimed at capturing flows between Asean and Greater China. The targets appear achievable if execution meets expectations, and economic conditions cooperate.
- The shift in capital management including its S\$2.5bn capital return plan over 2Y and dividend payout of ~60% have helped address some of the historical concerns on capital. Further, post GE, there is scope for capital management to step up. However, the bank's announced management change may weigh on the stock unless the communication from the incoming CEO suggests a sharp increase in payouts.
- Apart from increased dividends and buybacks, another potential use of capital could be via M&A; otherwise, we see ROEs coming off in the next 3Y on lower NIM. If a transaction were to be announced, share price moves would be a function of pricing and fit.
- We expect 22bps/12bps NIM compression in FY25/26E, following a sharp 23bps decline over the last 4 quarters, as well as declines in SORA and HIBOR. OCBC has 37% of loans in SGD and 11% in HKD.
- The bank has expanded inorganically over the last 10-15 years, with Wing Hang and Bank of Ningbo being notable transactions. There appears to be a commitment to deepen this presence, with capabilities being broadened in the GBA and HK markets, among others. This could lead to near-term risks if the growth in Greater China is via inorganic means and transactions are not immediately accretive.

Valuation

Our Jun-26 PT of S\$18 is based on a fair P/B of 1.21x, assuming a normalized RoE of 12.4%, a risk-free rate of 4.7%, a cost of capital of 10.4% and a growth rate of 1.0%.

Risks to Rating and Price Target

Upside risks include a significant improvement in DPS, meaningfully value-accretive deal, better than-expected growth at GE, and better-than-expected WM fees. Bank of Ningbo (20%-owned by OCBC) has competitive advantages in local SMEs and high-net-worth retail clients, which can drive faster growth at the group.

Downside risks include weaker than expected NIM, market share losses in wealth management, and M&A, if transactions are not immediately accretive.

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OCBC Bank (OCBC.SI, OCBC SP) Price Chart



Date	Rating	Price (\$)	Price Target (\$)
01-Nov-22	N	12.13	13
06-Jan-23	OW	12.44	14
09-Mar-23	OW	12.55	13.5
30-Mar-23	UW	12.53	11.5
13-Mar-24	UW	13.09	12.5
10-May-24	NR	13.91	--
13-Jul-25	N	16.89	18

Source: Bloomberg Finance L.P. and J.P. Morgan; price data adjusted for stock splits and dividends.
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